

Metal-Revettted Door

From the mosque of Sultan al-Mu`ayyad Shaykh

Burji Mamluk, 818-24 AH / 1415-21 CE

Wood and Brass or Bronze

W: 120 cm; H: 345 cm

Hall 1

Inv. no. 1065

Museum records note that this door was recovered from the mosque of Sultan al-Mu`ayyad Shaykh (818-24 AH / 1415-21 CE). Yet during the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, the building served as a repository and conservation workshop for architectural salvage from across Historic Cairo. Was the door commissioned for the site, or did it arrive from elsewhere? A clue may resolve the question: a fragmentary naskh inscription preserves a prayer invoking "survival, elation, and ascension", a standard supplication linked to the sultan by his contemporary al-Qalqashandi (756-821 AH / 1355-1418 CE). This textual evidence suggests the door was likely original to the mosque itself, not a later arrival. Traces of its former metal revetment survive in the central bukhariyya medallion, faint remnants of a once-gleaming surface that would have commanded attention within the sultan's architectural complex.